

Component 3: Theatre Makers in Practice

Overview

This component focuses on the work of theatre makers and the theatrical choices that are made by crucial members of the creative and production team in order to communicate ideas to an audience. As theatre makers, students will develop their knowledge and understanding of the ways in which drama can create meaning for an audience through performance.

Students will explore practically how a complete performance text might be interpreted and realised from 'page to stage'. This exploration will give students an insight into how texts may be brought to life for an audience and the creative roles within this process.

Students will also analyse and evaluate their experience of a live theatre performance as informed members of the audience. They will develop skills to recognise the meaning created in the theatre space in order to communicate ideas to an audience. This will give them a more critical and varied approach to their own work as theatre makers.

Content

There are **two** areas of focus.

1. Study of one complete performance text.
2. A live theatre evaluation.

Text choice

Centres have a choice when selecting what live theatre visits to make. However, for Section A they must select **one** performance text. The texts have been grouped into two time periods and categorised by genre and playwright. List A consists of pre-1954 texts and List B represents post-2000 texts.

List A (pre-1954)

Performance text	Genre	Prescribed edition*
<i>A Doll's House</i> , Henrik Ibsen (adapted by Tanika Gupta)	Historical drama	Methuen Drama (Bloomsbury) ISBN 9781350261075
<i>An Inspector Calls</i> , J B Priestley	Social thriller/mystery	Heinemann ISBN 9780435232825
<i>Antigone</i> , Sophocles (adapted by Roy Williams)	Tragedy	Methuen Drama (Bloomsbury) ISBN 9781350260849
<i>Government Inspector</i> , Nikolai Gogol (adapted by David Harrower)	Black comedy	Faber & Faber ISBN 9780571280490
<i>The Crucible</i> , Arthur Miller	Historical drama	Methuen Drama Student Edition ISBN 9781350245778
<i>Twelfth Night</i> , William Shakespeare	Romantic comedy	New Longman Shakespeare ISBN 9780582365780

List B (post-2000)

Performance text	Genre	Prescribed edition*
<i>100</i> , Diene Petterle, Neil Monaghan and Christopher Heimann	Ensemble story-telling	Nick Hern Books ISBN 9781854597373
<i>1984</i> , George Orwell, Robert Icke and Duncan Macmillan	Political satire	Oberon Plays ISBN 9781783190614
<i>Blue Stockings</i> , Jessica Swale	Historical drama	Nick Hern Books ISBN 9781848423299
<i>DNA</i> , Dennis Kelly	Black comedy	Oberon Plays ISBN 9781840029529 (school edition)/ 9781350188044 (student edition) [†]
<i>The Free9</i> , In-Sook Chappell	Tragedy/ensemble story-telling	Methuen Drama (Bloomsbury) ISBN 9781350261037
<i>Gone Too Far!</i> , Bola Agbaje	Social drama	Methuen Drama (Bloomsbury) ISBN 9781350258433

*The prescribed editions will be used to reproduce extracts for examination purposes. Centres are free to choose a different edition for teaching purposes.

[†]The 9781350188044 student edition will replace the current 9781840029529 school edition in terms of reproduction of extracts for examination purposes.

Contrast requirement

The performance text chosen for this component must be in contrast with the text used for performance in Component 2 and centres must inform Pearson of their choices, please see pages 6–8 for more details.

The study of one performance text

Students must study **a complete performance text** and then will respond to an **unseen extract** from their chosen performance text in the examination. The unseen extract will be from a scene or moment that is significant to the text as whole. Extracts will be between 80–100 lines long (this includes spoken dialogue and stage directions). Please note performance texts are not permitted in the examination.

Students must practically consider the ways and develop ideas in which performers, directors and designers create impact and meaning through the elements of performance, including:

- acting style and purpose, including vocal and physical skills
- set and props, including stage furniture and personal props
- lighting and sound, including colour and music
- costume, makeup and masks as appropriate
- use of stage space and spatial relationships, including levels and entrance points
- intended impact and meaning for the audience.

Students must contribute to exploration of the performance text, so that they are able to offer possible interpretations from the perspective of performer, director or designer.

Practical work should involve gaining knowledge and understanding to explore:

- the playwright's use of meaning, genre, structure, character, form, style, language and stage directions for communication between performer and audience
- vocal and physical interpretation of character
- design elements, including staging and visual communication, costume, lighting, set and sound
- sketches and drawings to represent stage space
- performance style and theatrical devices.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- understand the practices used in twenty-first century theatre-making
- understand production elements and theatrical conventions
- understand the role of theatre makers in contemporary practice including performers, directors and designers
- understand how the meaning of a text might be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- understand social, historical and/or cultural contexts including the theatre conventions of the period which the text was created and performed*
- use appropriate vocabulary and subject-specific terminology.

Skills

Students must develop the ability to:

- analyse and evaluate the work of theatre-makers
- recognise specific challenges for performers, directors and designers based on their own experiences in exploring the chosen text
- analyse and evaluate the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre
- use subject-specific terminology in discussing their work as theatre makers.

Students must also be aware of, and be able to use appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Live theatre evaluation

Students will reflect on their experience as an informed member of an audience at a live theatre performance, enabling them to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of performance through analysis and evaluation.

When choosing a performance the following should be taken into consideration:

- it must not be a prescribed text from Component 3
- it should ideally demonstrate a range of production elements, for example costume, set, sound, lighting
- it should present opportunities for students to analyse and evaluate the work of key theatre makers, performers, directors and designers
- it must provide opportunities for students to use subject-specific terminology.

For the purposes of this qualification, live theatre means being a member of the audience in the same performance space as the performers. It does **not** include any performance that is sung-through in its entirety.

**For those List A texts that have been adapted, namely: A Doll's House, Antigone, and Government Inspector we require students to consider the theatrical conventions of the period in relation to the original text.*

The performance can be an amateur or professional production as long as the choice enables students to access the demands of this component.

It is desirable for students to see as much live theatre as possible throughout the course, although only **one** performance will be written about in the examination.

Centres are reminded that they must submit a live performance statement to Pearson (please see *page 8* for details). If there are extreme extenuating circumstances regarding the access to live theatre for this component, then centres are required to contact drama.assessment@pearson.com.

Notes

Students are allowed to bring in theatre evaluation notes of up to a maximum of 500 words. These notes must be focused on **one** performance only and include the details of the title, venue and date seen. These notes should help them to demonstrate knowledge and understanding as an informed member of the audience.

These notes may include reference to:

- performers, including performers in specific roles
- design considerations, including the use of costume, set, lighting and sound
- the director's concept/interpretation and the chosen performance style
- impact on the audience, including, specifically, on the student, and how this was achieved
- the use of the theatre space
- how ideas were communicated during the performance.

Sketches, drawings and diagrams may also be included in the notes and used to support the response to the question if required.

No pre-published material, including programmes and photographs, may be taken into the examination or form part of the notes.

Notes may be handwritten or word processed but the total word limit must not be exceeded. Notes must not be submitted with the examination paper, but retained by the centre and kept until after post-results services deadline.

The notes must be attached to the form provided in *Appendix 2*.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- recognise and understand how theatrical choices are used by theatre makers to create impact
- understand how the meaning of a text can be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- use appropriate vocabulary and subject-specific terminology.

Skills

Students must develop the ability to:

- analyse and evaluate the work of theatre makers
- form critical judgements about live theatre based on their understanding of drama and theatre
- analyse and evaluate the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre
- analyse and evaluate the work of others.